

HOT OR COLD?

WHAT WORKS BEST

For injured athletes, the road to recovery can seem endless and, at times, perplexing. The desire for a speedy return to the field often leads athletes to seek ways to expedite the healing process and alleviate pain. However, there's a caveat: strategies employed to reduce immediate pain might not align well with those that accelerate healing.

TWO CONTRASTING THERAPIES ARE COMMONLY USED ICE PACKS AND HEAT THERAPY.

Ice therapy provides immediate relief by numbing pain receptors and constricting blood vessels, thereby reducing inflammation and swelling. However, there is a catch: reducing the inflammation can also hinder the healing process.

Inflammation is the body's natural response to injuries, wherein the white blood cell count is elevated, fighting potential invaders and removing damaged cells. Inflammation physically protects the injured area, creating a safe environment for new tissue growth. The increased blood flow, a crucial part of the inflammatory response, delivers essential nutrients to fuel the growth of these new tissues.

Another method used is heat therapy; since its mechanics are opposite to cold, heat therapy increases blood flow and, consequently, the inflammatory response. However, heat therapy isn't advisable immediately after an injury as excessive inflammation can further harm the tissues."

ICE VS HEAT

REDUCES PAIN AND SWELLING	PROMOTES BLOOD FLOW AND INFLAMATTORY RESPONSE; SOOTHES AND REDUCES PAIN
FOR UPTO A MAXIMUM OF 48-72 HOURS AFTER INJURY	USED AFTER APPROX 48-78 HOURS AND FOR CHRONIC INJURIES
MAY DELAY HEALING IF USED EXCESSIVELY	RISK OF BURNS
CAN DAMAGE SKIN AND TISSUES IF APPLIED DIRECTLY AND CAUSE POTENTIAL NERVE DAMAGE	NOT RECOMMENDED FOR OPEN WOUNDS OR ACUTE INJURIES

Halt Sports Injuries (HSI) : An Ortho One Initiative to create awareness through learning sessions and provide medical support at subsidised cost for deserving sports persons.
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